

MASTER PLANNERS The working group of artists' organisation HH Art Spaces

A. J. JOJI

drawn on local craftsmanship. For instance, Dineo Seshee Bopape from South Africa is collaborating with traditional house builders to construct her mud domes. Monica de Miranda from Lisbon is working with artisans skilled in rammed earth technique and Dhiraj Rabha from Assam is partnering with bamboo workers.

This year's edition includes several first-time venues, with the Biennale extending into the life of the city beyond its familiar spaces. "For the first time, we don't have access to the entire Aspinwall House—only to one third of this incredible, expansive space. This allows us to decentralise the Biennale and surprise audiences by activating spaces they've never seen before with installations and exhibitions," says Chopra. One of the new venues is Willingdon Island, which is a short ferry ride from Fort Kochi. It will host works by artists like Aarti Kadam, Raja Boro, Himanshu Jamod, Lakshmi Nivas Collective, Sabitha Kadanapalli and Sayan Chanda. Closer to the end of the 90-metre space, visitors will encounter Meenu James from Kerala, presenting small, detailed paintings depicting scenes from her coastal village. Further along, Vinoja Tharmalingam from Sri Lanka will display large sculptural works that look like bunkers, echoing her childhood in Jaffna. The exhibition will culminate at Marina Abramovic's installation *Waterfall*, a three-channel projection of 100 monks and nuns, all chanting to create a continuous sound that resembles a waterfall. "Walking through Dineo's womb-like structures, (then) experiencing themes of war, conflict, and rebirth with Vinoja and Marina—this journey aims to embody the cycle of birth and transformation," adds Chopra. ■

—Prachi Joshi

The Biennale will run from Dec. 12, 2025 to Mar. 31, 2026

watched communities create, artisans find global recognition, and audiences rediscover what culture means to them."

This year, more than 35 curators have come together to imagine a future where art continues to expand its reach. The stellar line-up of curators across disciplines such as visual arts, dance, music, theatre, design, and culinary innovation includes actor-director Lillete Dubey, musicians Ehsaan Noorani and Shubha Mudgal, art historian Anjana Somany, artist Sudarshan Shetty, tabla maestro Aneesh Pradhan, poet Ranjit Hoskote, multi-disciplinary designer Sandeep Sangaru and theatre director Anuradha Kapur.



The visual arts section includes highlights such as Sudarshan Shetty's *A Breath Held Long*, a 25-minute video that merges documentary filmmaking with theatre and music and Thukral & Tagra's *Multiplay* serves as a sandbox for collective experiences. *Remember Me* is part of the Photography section, a project documenting and re-imagining artist Divya Cowasji's family history through objects and family lore. Musicians Ranjit Barot and Zubin Balaporia curate a tribute to Ustad Zakir Hussain titled 'Ustad', while River Raag enthrals audiences with its unique sunset cruises featuring classical performances. Theatre highlights include plays such as *Bob Marley from Kodihalli* and *Nihsango Ishwar*. There are also dance performances by acclaimed artistes and projects across crafts and culinary arts. A number of special projects are also part of this year's line-up of programmes. ■

—Deepali Dhingra

Serendipity Arts Festival 2025 will be held from Dec. 12-21 in Panjim, Goa